the mentalities, value system, and public opinion of both domestic and foreign political systems. Professional diplomats conduct negotiations or provide supportive roles if the political leaders or other envoys are involved in the negotiation.

Obtaining Information: This is the most delicate task of the diplomat as information and data are the raw materials of foreign policy. Data concerning military potential, personalities and economic trends or problems must be supplied to the policy makers in his country so that they can decide their course of action. The diplomat's chief function is providing information by using his skills and familiarity with the foreign society in order to interpret the data and make reliable assessments and forecasts of responses of the receiving government towards the policies of his own government.[18]

Reporting: The data and information collected from the receiving country must be reported to the diplomat's own government. These reports cover every conceivable subject, which may be important for his country. As a publication of the United States Department of State states the American Foreign Service expects its diplomats to "observe, analyze, and report on political, social and economic conditions and trends of significance in the country in which they are assignees".[19]

Protection of National Interests: Although a diplomat is expected to be *persona grata* to the government of the state, i.e., he must get along with the government of the country he is accredited to, yet protecting and furthering the national interest of his country is his prime duty. This is the bedrock of the practice of the diplomacy.

Protection of Nationals Abroad: This involves protecting the lives and promotion of interests of nationals residing or travelling abroad. This is a routine task but during catastrophes or civil disorders, the role of diplomats becomes crucial especially when the local government fails or does not provide the security of the lives and property of the foreign nationals.

Though diplomacy has evolved from its traditional form to its modern form and considerable changes have taken place in foreign relations, the essential functions of diplomacy and those of the diplomats have remained unchanged. The chief functions of diplomacy: the